STUDENT GUIDE

Master of Science in Artificial Intelligence

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1.0 Welcome Message from the Dean

Welcome to the Master of Science in AI,

You are joining this program at a defining moment for higher education, professional practice, and leadership. In an era shaped by artificial intelligence and rapid global change, the true value of advanced education lies not in the accumulation of knowledge, but in the ability to apply judgment, act with confidence, and lead responsibly in complex environments.

This Master's program has been designed with that purpose at its core. It combines academic rigor with industry relevance, with a strong emphasis on project-based learning grounded in real professional challenges. Throughout your studies, you will work on applied projects that reflect the realities of today's organizations—developing not only expertise, but also the ability to translate insight into impact.

We approach artificial intelligence not as a standalone subject or a replacement for human expertise, but as a capability multiplier. Across the curriculum, you will learn to work effectively with emerging technologies while strengthening the human skills that matter most: critical thinking, ethical judgment, adaptability, and leadership. Our goal is to prepare graduates who can navigate uncertainty, make informed decisions, and create value in an AI-enabled world.

A defining strength of this program is our partnership with Woolf, a global collegiate higher education institution committed to academic excellence, innovation, and robust governance. Through this collaboration, the program is grounded in internationally recognized academic standards while remaining flexible, modern, and responsive to the needs of working professionals. Woolf's framework ensures that innovation is matched by quality, integrity, and scholarly depth.

Our faculty and contributors combine academic expertise with industry experience, creating a learning environment that values inquiry, collaboration, and application. You are not here to collect content—you are here to develop judgment, confidence, and the ability to act in moments that matter.

Our promise is simple: you will engage with a degree that is academically rigorous, professionally relevant, and designed for leadership in an AI-enabled world. We are proud to welcome you to our academic community and look forward to supporting you throughout this journey.

Warm regards,

Kai Römmelt

Dr. Kai Römmelt
Dean, Udacity Institute of AI & Technology | CEO of Udacity, Part of Accenture

2.0 How the Program Works

This Master's program is a rigorous, applied, and professionally oriented academic degree, offered with the flexibility of learning at your own pace. It is designed to accommodate different professional and personal circumstances while maintaining consistent academic standards and learning outcomes across all modes of study.

The program combines scholarly foundations with project-based learning, enabling students to work on authentic challenges that reflect real-world professional contexts. Whether pursued full-time or part-time, students are expected to engage deeply with the curriculum, apply concepts in practice, and demonstrate graduate-level critical thinking and independence.

The program emphasizes:

- Academic rigor aligned with internationally recognized standards
- Industry-relevant, project-based learning
- Consistent expectations and assessment across study modes

2.1 Program Duration & Structure

This Master's program is fully online and self-paced, offering flexibility while maintaining the academic rigor of a formally accredited graduate degree. The program is structured using the European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System (ECTS) and represents a total workload of approximately 2,250 learning hours, equivalent to 90 ECTS credits, including 750 hours dedicated to the capstone project.

Because the program is self-paced, completion time varies based on individual circumstances. Most students complete the degree within 18 to 24 months, whether studying part time or full time. While schedules are flexible, all students are held to the same academic standards, learning outcomes, and assessment criteria.

Your master's degree is structured across three learning tiers, designed to guide you from foundational knowledge to advanced, applied work. This tiered approach ensures academic rigor while allowing you to progressively build expertise and practical skills.

Tier 1: Core Modules (875 hours)

Tier 1 courses are mandatory for completing the full master's degree. They establish the core knowledge and technical foundations required for advanced study and for successfully completing the capstone project. These courses focus on essential concepts in artificial intelligence, data analysis, programming, and ethical practice.

Your foundational learning includes the following eight industry-relevant Nanodegree programs:

- Agentic AI
- Generative AI
- AI Programming with Python
- Intro to ML with Pytorch
- Data Analysis
- Statistics for Data Analysis
- Ethical Artificial Intelligence Practices
- Deep Learning

These courses build the technical, analytical, and ethical foundations required for advanced AI practice. Together, Tier 1 courses prepare you for the capstone project.

Tier 2: Elective Modules (625 hours)

Tier 2 allows you to tailor your learning path based on your interests and professional goals. You may choose from a [catalog of more than 40 Nanodegree programs] to fulfill your elective module credit hours. These options enable you to deepen your expertise in particular AI domains or applied use cases while remaining aligned with the academic requirements of the master's program. On average, Tier 2 is completed through approximately five Nanodegree programs.

Tier 3: Capstone (750 hours)

Tier 3 focuses on applied, project-based learning. In these courses, you will synthesize knowledge from earlier tiers to solve complex, real-world problems. The capstone project represents the culmination of your master's studies. See section 2.3 for more details on what's included with the capstone.

2.2 Progress as Reflected on Woolf Transcript

Udacity Nanodegree programs are mapped to Woolf's fully accredited courses such that we can provide academic credit for time spent learning with Udacity. Because of this, students will see the name of the Woolf Course in their Woolf transcript and not necessarily the name of the Udacity Nanodegree program.

Each Woolf course is made up of one or more Nanodegree programs. A Nanodegree program is a structured learning unit focused on specific learning outcomes and includes guided content, practice activities, and a required project submission. Successfully passing the project is required to complete the Nanodegree program and earn course credit for the degree.

Woolf courses may also include peer literature reviews, recommended reading lists, and topic-related assignments or exercises. These activities are formative and are designed to support learning, academic engagement, and preparation for the project, but they do not count toward the final grade unless explicitly stated.

The mapping is straightforward for the Core Modules:

Udacity Nanodegree Program	Woolf Course Name
Agentic AI	Intelligent Systems
AI Programming with Python	Introduction to Computer Programming: Part 1
Data Analyst	Applied Data Analytics
Statistics for Data Analysis	
Deep Learning	Introduction to Deep Learning
Ethical Artificial Intelligence Practices	Ethical Artificial Intelligence Practices
Generative AI	Introduction to Artificial Intelligence
Introduction to Machine Learning with Pytorch	Introduction to Machine Learning

However, electives operate differently, as the Nanodegree programs included in the elective catalog sometimes reuse the same lessons or courses. To complete the elective module, students must complete 625 unique credit hours. The implication of this is that if a student takes two Nanodegree programs that share content, they will only earn unique credit hours the first time they complete that lesson or course. This is aligned with how progress is reflected in Udacity today. In the Udacity student experience, students will see that they've already completed a given lesson or course when they open a new Nanodegree program that shares content with a Nanodegree program they've already completed.

In practice, progress made for the Nanodegree programs that are electives will be distributed across multiple Woolf courses until the required credit hours are reached. At that point, the credit will be locked and rolled into a single course such that it reflects as completed on your transcript. Until the course is locked, some movement between Woolf courses is normal and expected, it simply means you are closer to earning credit towards a course than you were before. For example, the Data Scientist Nanodegree program is an elective and is mapped to multiple Woolf courses. As you make progress in that Nanodegree program you will see that progress reflected across multiple Woolf courses wherever that mapping exists. But when you finish the Nanodegree program that credit will be rolled into a single course. All learning will be fully reflected in your credits as the system updates. This system was designed to maximize the number of credit hours you've earned through course completion.

You can reduce the number of electives you need to complete by applying for Recognition of Prior Learning. For more information, please read [Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) at Woolf](). As part of the Udacity Institute of AI and Technology, the Woolf RPL fee will be automatically waived for your first RPL application.

2.3 Capstone Project Guide

The AI Mastery Capstone is the final stage of your master's program. Its purpose is simple: to show that you can apply AI techniques to real-world problems, explain your decisions clearly, and reason responsibly about the systems you build.

This capstone is designed around professional practice. It mirrors how AI work actually happens in industry: building systems, testing them, documenting what you did, and explaining why your choices make sense. All parts must be submitted in English.

By the end of the capstone, you should have a body of work that you could reasonably discuss in a job interview or include in a professional portfolio.

How the Capstone is Structured

The capstone is made up of seven projects. Each project focuses on a different AI skill area and produces a concrete artifact, such as a notebook, script, system design, or applied analysis.

You can complete the projects in any order. They do not depend on one another for completion. However, they are intentionally designed to develop complementary skills that come together in the final project.

The projects cover:

- Programming and reproducible workflows
- Data analysis and statistical reasoning
- Machine learning modeling and evaluation
- Deep learning systems
- Generative AI applications
- Agentic AI systems
- A final integrative industry synthesis

Each project stands on its own, but together they represent a full spectrum of applied AI practice.

How the Capstone is Assessed

Across all projects, the focus stays consistent. Reviewers are looking for your ability to:

- Define a problem clearly
- Choose appropriate methods or architectures
- Implement systems that run as expected
- Evaluate results honestly
- Identify limitations and risks
- Explain your reasoning in a clear, structured way

High performance metrics or "perfect" outputs are not the goal. Thoughtful decision-making and clear communication matter more than optimization.

The Writing Component

Every project includes a written report. This is intentional and reflects professional expectations for communicating your work in a clear manner.

In jobs that develop and work on AI, you are expected to explain what you built, why you built it that way, what worked, what didn't, and what the implications are. Code alone is rarely enough. The reports give you practice doing this in a structured way.

Citations

As part of each written project report, you must include a list of citations. Citations are used to support definitions, justify design choices, and frame ethical considerations. They show where key ideas come from and how your work connects to established knowledge. In addition, backing up your ideas with citations will also give you an opportunity to explore the latest innovations in the field you chose to focus on in the Capstone.

How the Projects Connect

Although the projects of the capstone can be completed independently, they build toward a larger story about your capabilities. You begin by showing that you can write clean, reproducible code and reason about data. You then move into building and evaluating machine learning and deep learning models. Later projects focus on generative systems and agentic workflows, where system design and responsibility become more important. The final project brings these skills together in a single, industry-focused synthesis.

The Final Synthesis Project

The final project is where everything comes together. You will choose an industry or application domain and design an AI solution that integrates methods and insights from at least three earlier projects. This includes:

- A new applied artifact or system design
- A reflective synthesis paper explaining how your earlier work informed your decisions
- A mentor meeting where you defend your design and ethical reasoning

Capstone Assessment and Grading Structure

The AI Mastery Capstone is graded across eight assessed components. While the capstone includes seven core projects, the final project contains two separately graded parts, resulting in eight total graded submissions.

Projects 1 through 6 collectively account for 60 percent of the final capstone grade. Each of these projects is weighted evenly within that portion of the assessment and evaluates specific applied AI competencies developed throughout the program.

Project 7 is the final integrative project and is composed of two parts:

- Part 1: An industry-focused synthesis project and written synthesis paper (20 percent of final capstone grade)
- Part 2: An oral defense of your system design, decisions, and ethical reasoning (20 percent of final capstone grade)

Together, these two components account for 40 percent of the final capstone grade, reflecting their role in demonstrating integrated, professional-level AI practice. The synthesis project and paper represent the largest single weighting within the capstone assessment.

Resubmission Policy

Any project that requires resubmission is subject to a 10 percent reduction from the maximum possible score for that project. In addition, a mandatory one-week waiting period is required before a resubmission may be made. This policy applies to all graded components of the capstone, including both parts of the final project.

This grading structure emphasizes steady progress, professional accountability, and the ability to synthesize and defend applied AI work at a graduate level.

What Success Looks Like

Success in the capstone does not mean flawless models or production-ready systems. It means:

- Your work runs and behaves as described
- Your choices are reasonable and well-explained
- Your analysis is grounded in your own results
- Your writing communicates clearly to both technical and non-technical readers
- Your ethical reasoning is specific and tied to your system

If you can build something real, explain it clearly, and defend your reasoning, you are meeting the expectations of the AI Mastery Capstone. Upon passing the defense of your capstone, you will earn 30 ECTS credits.

Capstone Project on Woolf's Academic Management System (AMS) & Transcript

The Capstone Project is available on the Woolf platform and is formally mapped to the accredited Maltese license under [Capstone: Advanced Applied Computer Science](). In the official Woolf transcript, the Capstone Project is listed under “Capstone: Advanced Applied Computer Science”.

2.4 Grading, Pass/Fail Rules & Resubmissions

Assessment in this program follows a mastery-based, project-centered grading model aligned with commonly used higher-education grading standards. Each required project is evaluated against defined learning outcomes using a standardized rubric. The grade for each project is determined by the number of submissions required to achieve a passing evaluation, following a percentage scale that corresponds to widely used U.S. university grading conventions (e.g., 100% ≈ A, 90% ≈ A−/B+, 80% ≈ B):

- Pass on first submission: 100%
- Pass on second submission: 90%
- Pass on third submission: 80%
- Each additional submission results in a further 10% reduction

Practice assignments, quizzes, lessons, and other learning activities are formative and do not contribute to the final grade. They are designed to support learning, improve project quality, and reduce the number of resubmissions.

The final grade for a course is calculated as the average of the grades for all completed projects at the time the course is submitted for completion. Projects that have not yet been completed (i.e., not yet passed) are included in the calculation with a provisional grade of 0%.

Each project has clear pass criteria defined in its grading rubric. If a submission meets the rubric requirements, the project is marked as passed. If it does not yet meet the required standard, the student receives detailed feedback and may revise and resubmit until the pass criteria are met.

Project Submissions and Resubmissions

There is no fixed limit on the number of times a project may be submitted before it meets specifications. Students are encouraged to revise and resubmit their work based on reviewer feedback until all required learning outcomes are satisfied.

Projects may be resubmitted as long as each submission meaningfully addresses the feedback received and the project has not yet met specifications.

Once a project meets specifications, it is considered passed and complete. At that point, the assessment is finalized and further resubmissions are no longer possible.

2.5 Pausing the Program

Life circumstances can change, and the program is designed with flexibility in mind. You may pause your studies and resume the master’s program when you are ready to continue.

If you pause your subscription and later choose to re-enroll, you will not be required to pay the enrollment fee again. You may contact Udacity Support to reactivate your degree program and continue your studies from where you left off.

3.0 Graduation and Degree Issuance

3.1 Degree Award, Accreditation, and Legal Status

Upon successful completion of all academic requirements, students are awarded a Master of Science (MSc) in Artificial Intelligence. This is a formally accredited degree, equivalent in level and academic standing to other recognized master's degrees, and reflects completion of graduate-level coursework, assessments, and a final capstone project.

The program is delivered through the Udacity Institute of AI and Technology, a member college of Woolf, where students complete a hands-on, project-based curriculum while earning ECTS credits transferable across more than 50 countries. The degree is awarded by Woolf, a global collegiate higher education institution.

Woolf is fully licensed by the Malta Further and Higher Education Authority (MFHEA) and operates under the European Bologna Process, ensuring academic quality, transparency, and international recognition of credits. Woolf holds legal responsibility for academic governance and quality assurance, validation of programs and learning outcomes, issuance of official degrees and transcripts, and compliance with applicable higher education regulations. The Udacity Institute of AI and Technology delivers the learning experience and curriculum, while Woolf serves as the degree-awarding and accrediting institution.

Accreditation provides important assurances for students. Academic standards, assessments, and learning outcomes are formally validated, the degree is issued within the ECTS framework, and official transcripts and diplomas are verifiable. The qualification may be considered for further study or professional purposes, subject to local regulations and institutional policies.

3.2 Transcripts, Diploma Issuance & Professional Portfolio

Upon successful completion of the program, graduates receive an official digital diploma and an official academic transcript, both awarded by Woolf. The transcript details completed coursework, credits, and academic outcomes. These documents include secure verification features, allowing employers and institutions to confirm their authenticity.

Diplomas and transcripts follow approved academic formats and naming conventions required for accreditation and recognition. While internal course or program names used during study may differ, official records reflect the accredited academic titles.

In addition to formal academic credentials, graduates complete a portfolio of applied projects developed throughout the program. This portfolio demonstrates the practical application of artificial intelligence concepts through real-world projects, including AI systems, data analysis, machine learning and deep learning applications, generative and agent-based solutions, and written analyses explaining design decisions, trade-offs, limitations, and ethical considerations.

Students can export/download their work product and share it externally. This project portfolio supports career development and professional progression by providing tangible evidence of applied skills and judgment. While it is not a formal credential or substitute for the degree, students are encouraged to curate and present it responsibly in line with professional, ethical, and confidentiality standards.

4.0 Roles, Support & Who to Contact

4.1 Your Support Ecosystem at a Glance

At Udacity, your learning experience is supported by a dedicated ecosystem designed to help you stay on track throughout your master's program. Whether you are navigating the learning platform, working on projects, or seeking guidance, support is always available.

As a master's student, you have access to mentors, project reviewers, community managers, other students in the master's program, and moderators within the official Master of Science in AI community. In addition, Udacity's Support team is available to assist with questions related to the Udacity classroom, enrollment, and overall program logistics.

4.2 Mentors: Role, Scope, and Expectations

Throughout your studies, you will be supported by Udacity mentors who specialize in the Nanodegree programs that make up your master's degree. Mentors are experienced practitioners who provide academic and technical guidance within the official Master of Science in AI community.

Mentors can support you by:

- Answering questions about course content, projects, and technical concepts
- Helping you debug issues and interpret project rubrics
- Breaking down complex topics into manageable steps
- Sharing study strategies, learning tips, and motivational guidance
- Pointing you to relevant resources and best practices

Mentors aim to respond to questions within a reasonable timeframe and focus on helping you progress academically.

Mentors are not able to:

- Make administrative decisions regarding grades, degree progress, extensions, or academic standing
- Address questions about tuition, enrollment status, transcripts, ECTS credits, or Woolf academic policies
- Complete projects or assessments on your behalf

For program logistics, degree requirements, or administrative matters, please contact Udacity Support. This separation allows mentors to focus on high-quality academic support while support teams manage official program matters.

4.3 Project Reviewers

Your projects and assessments are evaluated by Udacity's mentors. Their role is to ensure that your work meets the academic standards of the program and to provide clear, actionable feedback to support your learning. Reviewers will:

- Evaluate each submitted project against a standardized rubric aligned with program learning outcomes
- Provide written feedback highlighting strengths and areas for improvement
- Indicate whether a project meets requirements or requires revisions before credit is awarded
- Suggest concrete next steps to guide resubmission when changes are needed

All projects are assessed using the same rubrics and quality standards to ensure fairness, consistency, and academic integrity across all students.

4.4 Help & Technical Support

Udacity's Help Center is available 24/7 and provides guides, FAQs, and troubleshooting articles on common topics such as platform navigation, classroom access, project submissions, and technical issues. Dedicated resources are also available for master's program–specific questions, allowing many issues to be resolved quickly.

For technical, platform, or Udacity account–related questions, students should contact Udacity Support through the online support form and select Master of Science in Artificial Intelligence under enrollment. This ensures your request is routed to specialized master's support staff and allows you to include screenshots or additional details to support faster resolution.

Udacity Support can also be reached by email at support@udacity.com; however, using the online support form is recommended for the most efficient assistance.

After submitting a support request, you will receive confirmation that your case has been received. A Support Specialist will review your inquiry, and responses are typically provided within 24 to 48 hours. If further investigation is required, you will receive regular updates until the issue is resolved.

4.5 Master's of AI Learner Community

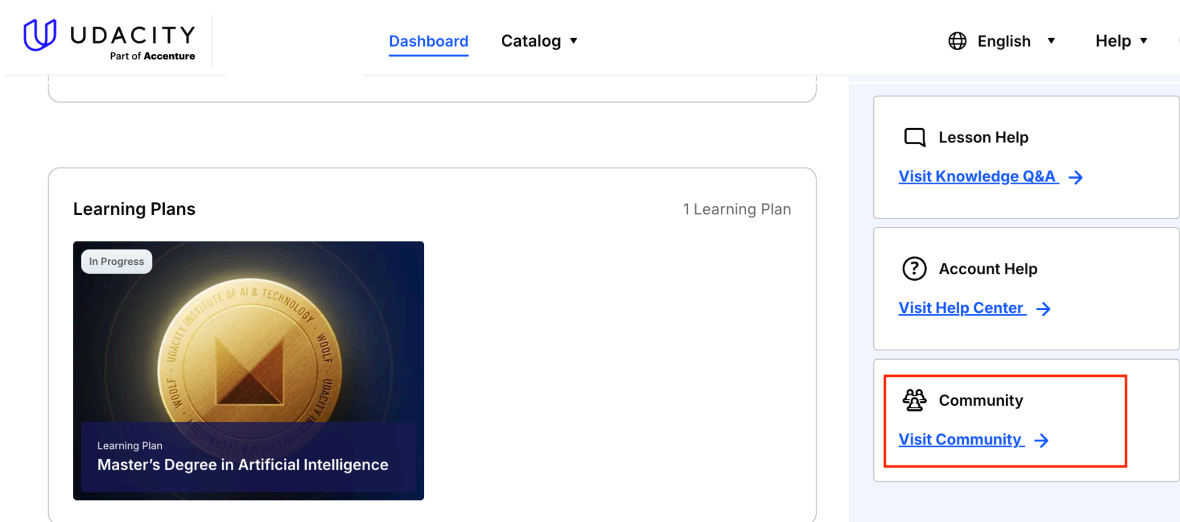
As a learner in the master's of AI program, you have access to a dedicated community exclusively for master's students. This community serves as a central space to connect with peers, mentors, and the Community Team, supporting collaboration, learning, and professional growth throughout the program.

You can access the community through your program welcome email, the access link in Udacity's classroom, or the access link available in the Woolf dashboard.

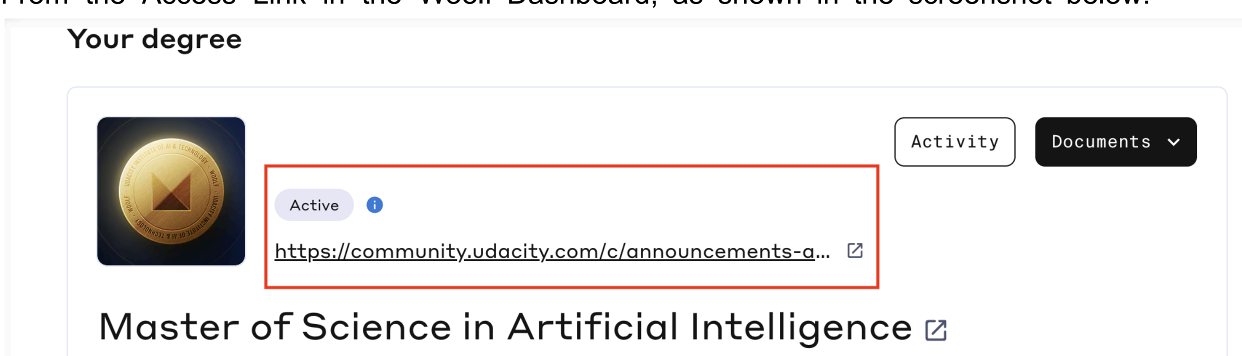
To get the most value from the community, students are encouraged to participate regularly, ask questions, contribute to discussions, share resources, and support fellow learners. Active engagement helps strengthen understanding and build meaningful professional connections.

You can access the community through any of the following options:

- From the welcome email you received after subscribing to the program.
- From the Access Link in Udacity's classroom, available in the right menu at the top-right corner of the classroom.



From the Access Link in the Woolf Dashboard, as shown in the screenshot below:



Getting Support in the Community:

- Community Team support is available for non-technical questions and general guidance
- Mentors and peers can assist with content-related and learning questions
- Udacity Support Specialists handle technical and account-related issues through the official support request form
- The learner community is designed to support you at every stage of your master's of AI journey.

5.0 Academic Integrity & Responsible AI Use

By joining the master's degree you agree to Udacity's honor code which can be found in the link below:

https://www.udacity.com/en-US/legal/honor-code